‘No, not at all,’ said Anirudhya.

‘Good. Just go for the kill. Good luck.’

‘Thanks, Inder ... thanks for the ...’ Badhwar had disconnected.

Kaarthikeyan was submerged in files, books, stacks of printouts and videocassettes.

Unlike the Mahatma Gandhi and Indira Gandhi assassinations, where some of the assailants were caught red-handed on the spot, in the case of Rajiv Gandhi there was no clue about the possible identity of the killers. *The Hindu* photograph was doing the rounds, but the SIT was still trying to figure out the characters in it. That they were Sri Lankan Tamils did not necessarily make them LTTE operatives. Kaarthikeyan feared it might end up like the Kennedy assassination case. He was studying cases of violent attacks and ambushes where extremist groups were involved in Tamil Nadu. There was a knock on the door. He didn’t hear. Someone pushed open the door slightly.

It was Radhavinod Raju, second in command in the SIT. Kaarthikeyan still hadn’t noticed. Raju cleared his throat.

‘Come in.’

‘I was leaving, so thought of saying good night.’

‘Sure. Good night.’

Raju was about to leave when Kaarthikeyan spoke again.

‘The CBI director has a meeting with the PM tomorrow morning. I was making some notes for him. While doing that, I came across some previous cases of crime where extremist groups were involved in Tamil Nadu. Very revealing, I must say.’

‘Can I take a look at them?’

‘Yes, yes. Let me finish reading them. After that I wanted to pass them on to you anyway.’

‘By all means.’

‘Thanks. Good night.’